

User Manual

“Charred Memory”

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Introduction

Charred Memory is a 2D pixel-art adventure game with elements of psychological horror. The application is designed for players who enjoy atmospheric storytelling and exploration. The user takes on the role of a knight awakening in a mysterious, burnt forest, tasked with distinguishing reality from a nightmare while being observed by a mysterious entity.

System Requirements

To ensure optimal performance of the Unity-based application, the following specifications are recommended:

- **Operating System:** Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit).
- **Processor:** Intel Core i3 / AMD Ryzen 3 or equivalent.
- **Memory:** 4 GB RAM minimum (8 GB recommended for multitasking).
- **Graphics:** DirectX 11 compatible graphics card.
- **Storage:** 500 MB available space.
- **Input:** Keyboard and Mouse (or standard Gamepad).

Getting Started

Follow these steps to install and launch the application:

1. **Installation:** Download the latest build **.zip** archive or clone the repository via GitHub. Extract all files to a dedicated folder (e.g., **D:\Games\Charred Memory**).
2. **Launch:** Locate the executable file (**CharredMemory.exe**) inside the folder and double-click to run.
3. **Menu:** Upon launching, the Main Menu will appear. Select "Play" to begin the narrative or "Options" to adjust audio settings.

Main Features

The system includes the following core functionalities:

- **Exploration:** Navigate the 2D environment using the **A** and **D** keys (or Left/Right Arrows). Use **Spacebar** to jump over obstacles.

- **Interaction:** Approach NPCs (such as the Crow) or objects and press **E** to interact or trigger dialogue sequences.
- **Settings Management:** Press **ESC** at any time to pause the game and open the Settings Menu.
 - **Volume Control:** Adjust the Master Volume slider. The system saves these preferences automatically across different levels (Scenes) using a persistent controller.
- **Scene Transition:** Move to the edge of the map to trigger transitions between the Forest and subsequent areas.

Troubleshooting

Common issues and their solutions:

- **Application Freeze / Low FPS:** If the game stutters, ensure that memory-intensive background applications (like web browsers with many tabs or Steam downloads) are closed, as the system requires available RAM.
- **No Audio:** If sound is missing, check the Windows Volume Mixer to ensure the application is not muted. If using headphones with specific drivers (e.g., Dolby Atmos), try disabling exclusive mode in Windows Sound Settings.
- **Save Data:** Currently, game progress is saved locally. If moving to a new device, the save folder must be copied manually to the new machine.